

Pasha Finkelshteyn

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PROFILE

Engineering leader with extensive experience in Java/Kotlin ecosystems, distributed data systems, and performance-oriented development. Led teams up to 40+, guided architectural decisions, improved startup performance for customer workloads, and contributed to high-impact tooling in the big-data space. Strong background in technical advocacy, cross-functional collaboration, and shaping engineering culture with a focus on efficiency and reliability.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Developer Advocate May 2024 — Present
BellSoft *Berlin, Germany*

- Delivered 40+ Java-focused talks worldwide, including deep dives into startup and runtime performance
- Participated in customer architecture reviews, providing data-driven technical recommendations

Developer Advocate for Big Data Tools and Kotlin February 2021 — April 2024
JetBrains *Berlin, Germany*

- Wrote a series of articles on Big Data concepts and tooling (<https://jb.gg/big-data-world>)
- Maintained the Kotlin API for Apache Spark, contributing to reliability and developer experience
- Authored “Data Engineering Annotated Monthly” (<https://jb.gg/de-annotated>)
- Defined and managed Kafka support for the Big Data Tools plugin, coordinating with engineering and external stakeholders
- Spoke at multiple conferences on Kotlin language features, performance, and tooling

Software Engineer February 2020 — February 2021
JetBrains *Moscow, Russia*

- Added support for Azure and Google Cloud storage providers to the Big Data Tools plugin for JetBrains IDEs
- Refactored the codebase to make broader use of `java.nio` for more predictable I/O behavior

Data Engineer September 2018 — February 2020
Lamoda Group *Moscow, Russia*

- Built a configuration-driven framework to replicate operational databases into Hadoop (Airflow, Spark, HOCON)
- Migrated PL/SQL procedures to Apache Spark pipelines
- Contributed to the data engineering platform of the company

CTO, Digital Business Division November 2017 — September 2018
Home Credit Bank *Moscow, Russia*

- Led 40+ employees, including 5 direct reports
- Rebuilt the development pipeline to increase visibility and predictability for stakeholders
- Improved development processes, reducing overtime to near zero
- Responsible for recruitment and offboarding
- Oversaw budgeting for the division

Development Tech Lead July 2016 — November 2017
DomClick *Moscow, Russia*

- Conducted a full architectural assessment in the first month; recommendations were implemented over the following year
- Hired a complete development team (4 developers, 1 QA)
- Introduced Kotlin into the tech stack and led its adoption
- Established development processes and collaborated with product managers on delivery and testing
- Achieved 6 months of production uptime without reported bugs; delivered multi-million-euro revenue with no losses

Software Architect December 2015 — July 2016
Atol *Moscow, Russia*

- Formed a team of 5 developers and 2 QA engineers
- Designed service architecture and delivered the initial production version
- Adopted Spring Cloud at an early stage to streamline service development
- Set up development processes suitable for rapidly changing startup requirements
- Coordinated with external partners on API integrations

Team Lead

February 2014 — December 2015

NII Voskhod

Moscow, Russia

- Managed a team of two engineers
- Delegated tasks and coordinated development efforts
- Reported to the software architect
- Participated in decisions on stack and architecture

Java Developer

March 2009 — January 2014

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Moscow, Russia

- Contributed to a secondary monitoring system for nuclear facilities
- Worked across a range of Java and web technologies, from legacy code to new components
- Performed refactoring and feature development in both legacy and greenfield projects

EDUCATION

Higher School of Economics

Moscow, Russia

*Master's in Business Psychology**2007 — 2009*

- Master's thesis: "Non-material Factors of Motivation"
- Earned high marks in courses related to organizational theory and business analysis

Higher School of Economics

Moscow, Russia

*Bachelor's in Organizational Psychology**2003 — 2007*